MICHAEL MAI

Creative Technology · Music Production · Communications
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PROFILE

Communications and customer-experience professional combining hospitality, retail and financial-services experience with hands-on creative technology projects. Connects cultural storytelling, audience-focused communication and AI-assisted production across 3D environments, music and editable design tools.

SELECTED CREATIVE PROJECTS

Huế Citadel — Ngọ Môn study: Directed an AI-assisted Blender entrance study informed by architectural references; produced an editable scene and rendered overview with documented scope limits.

Saigon Plaza: Shaped a Vietnamese café environment project through cultural direction, review and testing. Project evidence includes Unreal captures and an original three-prop Blender/FBX batch with documented export checks.

SIGNAL / AI: Developed an agency concept with AI-assisted production: a 14-slide pitch deck with speaker notes, desktop/mobile interface designs and a brand/UI board. Concept work, not a launched client business.

Music production — Freeway Shooting & Tripp: Creative direction, arrangement and stem-based production with AI-assisted mixing/mastering; final exports presented in an online listening portfolio.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Trung Nguyen Legend Cafe — Westminster, CA

Barista / Administrative Assistant / Community Manager | 2023–Present

- Support café operations and introduce Vietnamese coffee culture through product education, brand storytelling and customer engagement.
- Assist with inventory, scheduling, reporting, marketing and community communications; help refine operational processes.

loanDepot — Irvine, CA

Customer Lending Representative | December 2021–May 2022

- Helped customers understand lending products, requirements and next steps through needs-based conversations and clear follow-up.
- Documented customer information in digital systems while managing high-volume conversations.

Gap — South Coast Plaza, Costa Mesa, CA

Brand Associate | 2015–2021

- Provided product guidance and supported merchandising, replenishment and sales-floor operations in a high-traffic retail environment.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

VietRISE — Volunteer / Facilitator | 2022–Present
Support outreach and guide middle- and high-school students through discussions of cultural identity and community history.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

California State University, Long Beach — B.A., Communication Studies; Marketing minor, 2020.
Certificates: Mediation & Dispute Resolution; Professional Selling.
INNOCEAN advertising-agency classes during the pandemic; early exposure to AI.

SKILLS

Music production & arrangement · Stem-based workflows · Audience-focused writing · Cross-cultural communication · Blender · Unreal Engine · AI-assisted creative workflows · Operations support